

and offering a devout petition to Šamas, the sun-god, that the sacred shrines may now remain uninjured, closes with a prayer for his own well being and with a supplication for *Belšaruṣur* his first-born in almost the same words as the above. Why this especial mention of the king's son occurs in these inscriptions of Ur is doubtful. It may be conjectured with Tiele ('Geschichte,' 463) that *Belšaruṣur* was governor of this province in Southern Babylonia and had Ur as his capital, or it is possible that Nabonidus attached some special religious importance to the cult of the moon-god local in this place. The petition here that the king's son might not incline to sin may perhaps indicate that the prince had in some way offended the prejudices of the religious classes, who, as is well known, supervised the preparation of the inscriptions. From the allusion to the prince in the annals<sup>13</sup> of Nabonidus it appears that the son of the king was a number of years with the lords and army in Akkad, most probably in the capacity of commander in chief, while his father was residing in Tema free from the cares of government. It is worthy of notice here that in the annals the name *Belšaruṣur* does not occur, the allusion being merely to the 'son of the king'; but there can be little doubt that the reference is to the first-born.

In addition to these three passages from the historical literature, there are numbers of references to *Belšaruṣur* in the contract tablets, none of which, however, throw any further important historical light on his character.\*

As *Belšaruṣur* is the only king's son mentioned with such prominence in the Babylonian inscriptions,<sup>14</sup> and as it is espe-

<sup>13</sup> Annals, col. ii. 5, during the seventh year of Nabonidus, col. 2. 10, during the 10th year. See also col. ii. 19 and 23.

<sup>14</sup> Compare, however, Nbpl. col. ii. 69, 'Keilinschriftl. Bibl.' iii. pt. 2, 4, mention of Nebuchadnezzar; and col. iii. 6 ff. of *Nabušulīšir*, his brother. In later documents mention is made of Cambyses, son of Cyrus, as co-regent and king of Babylon during his father's lifetime. (See Tiele 'Geschichte,' 483, 484.) In the inscription of Antiochus Soter, VR. 66, 25, ('Keilinschr. Bibl.' iii. pt. 2, 138, 25), mention is made of Seleucus, his son and vice-king. Delattre, 'Solomon, Asurbanipal et Baltasar,' 1883, p. 5, compares in connection with *Belšaruṣur* the cases of Solomon and Sardanapalus, both of whom exercised the vice-regal dignity during the life of their respective fathers.

\* See additional note C.